CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 14: **The Elephant and the Tragopan** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Why does the poet make the trout, a water creature, the one who welcomes the reservoir? 1

(a) to prove fish are foolish
(b) to show water is dangerous
(c) to show that even apparent gainers will eventually suffer
(d) to praise dams

2. Which of these best describes the elephant's tone while correcting the trout? 1

(a) playful **(b)** ashamed
(c) furious **(d)** patient yet stern

3. An environmental slogan that best matches the poem is: 1

(a) Leave some forest for the animals too. **(b)** Reservoirs make everyone happy.
(c) Roads first, forests later. **(d)** Bamboo is useless.

4. The elephant's list of human qualities is meant to suggest that humans are: 1

(a) capable of both great good and great harm
(b) always wise
(c) always wicked
(d) unknowable

5. Which statement is an opinion about the poem? 1

(a) It features an elephant.
(b) It is by Vikram Seth.
(c) It is the best poem about nature ever written.
(d) It mentions a reservoir.

6. Which sentence is correct in grammar? 1

(a) The animals, who lived in the forest, were worried.
(b) The animals who living in forest worried.
(c) The animals which lives in the forest was worried.
(d) Animals the worried lived forest.

7. If humans are 'neither good nor bad but both', the poem's appeal is best aimed at: 1

(a) the tragopan alone **(b)** the animals
(c) their better side **(d)** the trout

8. The poet gives no direct moral at the end. This makes the reader: 1

(a) laugh **(b)** work out the lesson themselves
(c) ignore the message **(d)** forget the poem

9. Change to the passive: 'Humans destroy forests.' 1

(a) Forests destroyed by humans. **(b)** Forests are destroyed by humans.
(c) Humans are destroyed by forests. **(d)** Forests are destroying humans.

10. Which inference is best supported by 'When the road comes, the forest goes'? 1

(a) roads are made of wood
(b) forests like roads
(c) roads act as a first step in forest destruction
(d) forests cannot be cleared

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why is the trout's happiness ironic? 2

12. Why is the elephant a reliable speaker? 2

13. Use 'short-sighted' in a sentence about the trout. 2

14. What do the contradictory human qualities suggest? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse how irony works in the trout's response. 3

16. Discuss the idea of 'shared fate' in the poem. 3

17. Combine: 'The road came. The forest vanished.' 3

OR

How does personification help the poet convey his message? 3

18. Compare short-term gain and long-term loss using the poem. 3

OR

Explain the word 'contradictory' with examples from human behaviour. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The poem is a gentle but firm plea for living in harmony with nature.' Discuss. 5

OR

Imagine you are the tragopan. Write a diary entry after hearing the elephant's warning. 5

20. Critically appreciate 'The Elephant and the Tragopan'. 5

OR

'Short-term gain, long-term loss.' Discuss with reference to the trout. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND